

FAI Governance Offboarding

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This work derives from and formalizes the inter-Self coordination architecture introduced in “Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration” (Li, April 2026), the third paper in the CKS theory series following “Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems” (Li, April 2026) and “The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model” (Li, April 2026).

Abstract

A Self that has participated in Full Aspect Integration (FAI) events accumulates a governance infrastructure: a network participation configuration, partner preferences, standing configurations, cross-organizational governance agreements, and an active governance portfolio. When a Self decides to reduce or terminate its FAI participation, that infrastructure requires systematic governance wind-down — a process this note formalizes as FAI governance offboarding. Offboarding is distinguished from single-relationship exit (which terminates one FAI relationship while maintaining others) by its portfolio scope: offboarding addresses all active FAI infrastructure across some or all relationships. This note states the seven-step offboarding governance sequence, specifies what persists in the home substrate after offboarding is complete, covers the staged offboarding option for Selves that wish to assess whether partial reduction achieves their governance goals before full termination, identifies the silent offboarding anti-pattern and its partner impact, and provides an operational test for whether offboarding has been properly completed.

1. Offboarding distinguished from single-relationship exit

Two governance operations address the end of FAI participation, and they operate at different scopes.

Single-relationship exit (the subject of the prior exit-rights derivation note) terminates one specific FAI relationship while the Self continues participating in others. The governance work of single-relationship exit is bounded to that relationship: the cross-organizational governance

agreement covering that pair, the standing configurations specific to it, and the governance record of why that relationship is ending. The rest of the Self's FAI portfolio is unaffected.

FAI governance offboarding addresses the broader case: a Self that is reducing its FAI participation across a range of relationships, or terminating all FAI participation entirely. The governance work of offboarding is portfolio-scoped. Every active FAI event must be brought to proper dissolution. Every standing configuration must be revoked. Every cross-organizational governance agreement must be formally terminated. The network participation configuration must be updated to reflect the new participation level. The FAI governance portfolio must be closed or placed in a reduced-participation state.

The distinction matters because the governance obligations differ in kind. Single-relationship exit is a bounded bilateral governance act. Offboarding is a comprehensive governance close-down that touches every layer of FAI infrastructure the Self has built. Treating offboarding as a sequence of single-relationship exits executed in parallel misses the portfolio-level governance steps that offboarding requires: the governance decision record authorizing the wind-down, the network participation configuration update, the governance portfolio closure, and the comprehensive offboarding record that constitutes the Self's FAI history.

2. The offboarding governance sequence

Offboarding follows a seven-step governance sequence. The steps are ordered: later steps depend on the completion of earlier ones. Each step produces a governance record.

Step 1 — Governance decision and record

Offboarding begins as a home governance act. The governing humans within the Self make a decision to wind down FAI participation — specifying what participation is being wound down (some relationships, all relationships, or a reduction in participation volume), the reasons for that decision, and the governance authorization. This decision is recorded as home governance content.

The governance decision record serves two functions. Internally, it is the authorization that makes every subsequent offboarding step a governed act rather than an informal cessation of activity. Externally, it is the reference that partners can cite if they later need to understand why the Self's participation ended: the record exists, is dated, and is traceable.

The governance decision record is the first output of the offboarding sequence, and it is authored before any active FAI infrastructure is touched.

Step 2 — Active event closure

All active FAI events in which the Self is currently participating are brought to dissolution. Each event's dissolution follows the event's own dissolution governance: standard dissolution where circumstances permit, emergency dissolution where circumstances require. Each event's persistence policy governs what content propagates to home substrates at dissolution.

Step 2 is prerequisite to Step 3. Standing configurations cannot be revoked while active events that depend on those configurations are still running. The offboarding sequence closes the active layer before addressing the configuration layer.

Step 3 — Standing configuration revocation

All standing configurations — governance configurations that have been established to authorize and specify how FAI events with particular partners proceed — are revoked as home governance acts. Each revocation is recorded, with the revocation record noting which standing configuration is being revoked, the date of revocation, and the governance authorization. Partners are notified of each revocation through the cross-organizational agreement amendment process.

Standing configuration revocation is the step that closes the Self's pre-authorized participation capacity. After Step 3, no partner can initiate a new FAI event with the offboarding Self under a standing configuration that no longer exists. This is the governance mechanism that prevents new events from being initiated during or after offboarding.

Step 4 — Cross-organizational governance agreement termination

All cross-organizational governance agreements between the offboarding Self and its FAI partners are terminated per each agreement's termination governance. Termination notices are issued per the agreement's notification requirements.

Step 4 formalizes the end of the bilateral governance relationships within which FAI participation has operated. Where agreements carry survival clauses — provisions that specified obligations or rights persist beyond termination — those survival obligations are noted in the termination records.

The cross-organizational governance agreement termination step is the primary mechanism for ensuring partners have governance clarity about the end of the relationship. An agreement that is simply abandoned, rather than properly terminated, leaves both parties in ambiguous states regarding their mutual governance obligations.

Step 5 — Network participation configuration update

The network participation configuration — the home-substrate record specifying the Self's FAI participation parameters, partner preferences, propagation permissions, and participation scope — is updated to reflect the new participation state. Where offboarding is a full termination,

partner preferences are cleared and propagation permissions may be reduced to zero. Where offboarding is a reduction rather than full termination, the network participation configuration is updated to reflect the reduced scope.

The network participation configuration update is the infrastructure-layer step: it modifies the Self's standing posture in the FAI network, not merely its current active participation. After Step 5, the Self's home substrate accurately reflects what FAI participation the Self is now configured to support.

Step 6 — Governance portfolio closure

The FAI governance portfolio record — the home-substrate record that has been maintained throughout the Self's FAI participation, collecting post-mortem governance review records, governance improvement records, and the history of FAI events the Self has conducted — is closed or updated.

Outstanding post-mortem governance reviews should be completed before offboarding is finalized. Post-mortem reviews represent completed governance obligations that have not yet been discharged; carrying them open through portfolio closure leaves governance loose ends. Where circumstances do not permit completion before offboarding, the outstanding reviews are noted in the portfolio closure record.

Governance portfolio closure marks the administrative end of the Self's active FAI governance record. The portfolio record itself is not deleted — it remains as home governance content — but its status transitions from active to closed.

Step 7 — Offboarding record

The final step of the offboarding sequence is the authoring of a comprehensive offboarding record as home governance content. The offboarding record documents:

- All FAI events the Self conducted during its participation history (by reference to the governance records produced for each event)
- All governance learning retained from FAI participation (by reference to the evolution feed records and DNA absorption records produced during the Self's FAI history)
- All standing configurations revoked in Step 3 (by reference to the revocation records)
- All cross-organizational governance agreements terminated in Step 4 (by reference to the termination records)
- The final governance state of the FAI portfolio after closure

The offboarding record is the Self's FAI history record. It is not a summary drafted at the end of offboarding from memory; it is a governance document composed from references to the

governance records the offboarding sequence has produced. An observer who encounters the offboarding record should be able to trace every element it references back to the source governance record that documents that element.

3. What persists after offboarding

Offboarding terminates the Self's active FAI participation infrastructure. It does not erase the governance learning that FAI participation produced. Three categories of content persist in the home substrate after offboarding is complete.

Home substrate evolution records. Every DNA absorption and action-layer ingestion from prior FAI events remains in the home substrate. When the shared substrate dissolved at the close of each FAI event, governance-configured ingestion operated at the home perimeter, and the content taken through that ingestion became home substrate content. That content is not affected by offboarding. The governance learning from FAI participation — the orchestration patterns, edge-case protocols, and action-layer records accumulated through the Self's FAI history — persists in the home DNA and action layers after the FAI participation infrastructure that produced it has been wound down.

This persistence is the lasting structural value of FAI participation. A Self that participated in FAI events and then offboarded retains a richer home substrate than it had before participation began. The value of participation does not dissolve with the participation infrastructure.

Governance improvement records. All post-mortem governance review records produced during the Self's FAI participation history remain as home governance content. These records document what the Self's governance learned from each FAI event — what worked, what was revised, what governance improvements were authorized. They remain available for the Self's home governance operations after offboarding.

Locus 2 durable records. Governance records from completed FAI events that were configured to persist at the shared-substrate locus per the event's persistence policy continue to persist per those policies. The offboarding sequence does not retroactively modify the persistence policies of completed events.

4. Staged offboarding

Like onboarding, offboarding can be staged. A Self that is considering whether to terminate all FAI participation may first reduce participation — conducting fewer parallel events, narrowing sharing scopes, limiting the classes of partners with which standing configurations remain active — before taking the step of full termination.

Staged offboarding serves a governance assessment function. Full termination is difficult to reverse: once cross-organizational governance agreements are terminated and standing configurations are revoked, reconstituting the FAI participation infrastructure requires traversing the full onboarding sequence again. A Self that reduces participation first can observe whether reduced participation achieves its governance goals — whether the concerns that prompted the offboarding decision are addressed at reduced participation volume — before committing to full termination.

Staged offboarding is implemented through partial execution of the offboarding sequence. A Self reducing participation in one set of relationships while maintaining others executes Steps 2 through 7 for the relationships being wound down, while leaving the participation infrastructure for the maintained relationships intact. The network participation configuration (Step 5) is updated to reflect the reduced but not terminated participation level; the governance portfolio (Step 6) is updated rather than closed.

The governance discipline for staged offboarding is the same as for full offboarding: each stage of the wind-down produces governance records that document what participation infrastructure is being closed, under what authorization, and with what partner notifications.

5. Anti-pattern: silent offboarding

The silent offboarding anti-pattern describes a Self that stops FAI participation without completing the offboarding governance sequence. The Self simply ceases to initiate or accept FAI events, without revoking standing configurations, terminating cross-organizational governance agreements, updating its network participation configuration, or authoring an offboarding record.

Silent offboarding produces three governance failures.

Standing configurations remain active without governance authorization. Standing configurations that have not been formally revoked represent standing authorizations for partners to initiate FAI events under their terms. Partners who are unaware that the Self has informally exited may attempt to initiate FAI events under these still-active configurations. The resulting interactions occur against a configuration that the offboarding Self no longer governs — the standing configuration exists as substrate content, but no one is maintaining the governance authorization it depends on.

Cross-organizational governance agreements remain nominally in force. Agreements that have not been formally terminated retain their stated terms and any obligations those terms specify. The offboarding Self and its partners may have conflicting understandings of whether obligations under these agreements persist. The obligation ambiguity is not resolved by informal inactivity; it is resolved by formal termination.

The Self's governance record is incomplete. A Self that has not authored an offboarding record has no governance artifact documenting the end of its FAI participation. The FAI governance portfolio, if it exists, remains open. The governance decision to exit is unrecorded as an authorization. Future observers of the Self's governance record — including the Self's own home governance — cannot determine from the substrate whether the Self's FAI participation ended by governance decision or by operational drift.

The governance harm of silent offboarding falls on both the offboarding Self and its partners. Partners whose governance depends on accurate information about which Selves they have standing configurations with are left with outdated configuration records. The offboarding Self is left with a governance record that does not accurately reflect its participation history or governance decisions.

6. Operational test

Offboarding has been properly completed if all of the following are true:

1. A governance decision record exists in the home substrate documenting the offboarding decision, its authorization, and what participation is being wound down.
2. Every active FAI event that existed at the time offboarding began has a dissolution record traceable from the offboarding record.
3. Every standing configuration that existed at the time offboarding began has a revocation record, and partner notifications are documented.
4. Every cross-organizational governance agreement that existed at the time offboarding began has a termination record, with termination notices issued per the agreement's requirements.
5. The network participation configuration reflects the post-offboarding participation state.
6. The FAI governance portfolio is closed or updated to reflect reduced participation, and outstanding post-mortem reviews have been completed or noted.
7. A comprehensive offboarding record exists in the home substrate, referencing all seven completed steps and documenting the final governance state.

A Self for which all seven conditions are satisfied has completed offboarding as a governed act. An observer who begins from the offboarding record can trace every governance element the note references back to the source governance record that documents it. A Self for which any condition is not satisfied has not completed the offboarding governance sequence, regardless of whether active participation has ceased in practice.

7. The offboarding/onboarding symmetry

The onboarding governance sequence established, in its seven steps, the full infrastructure a Self requires before first FAI participation: governance authorization record, network participation configuration, partner preferences, cross-organizational governance agreements, standing configurations, FAI governance portfolio, onboarding record. The offboarding sequence closes each of those in sequence: governance decision record (the authorization closing), active event closure (clearing the running layer), standing configuration revocation (closing the configuration layer), cross-organizational agreement termination (closing the bilateral agreements), network participation configuration update (closing the infrastructure layer), governance portfolio closure (closing the portfolio record), offboarding record (the history record).

The correspondence is not accidental. The offboarding sequence was designed to close exactly what the onboarding sequence opened. The FAI governance lifecycle — from first participation to final exit — is complete: the infrastructure a Self builds to enter FAI participation has a governed close-down sequence at every layer.

This symmetry also supplies the structural explanation for why silent offboarding is a governance failure: it is not merely procedural incompleteness, but a failure to close governance infrastructure that was deliberately opened. The standing configurations, agreements, and portfolio records the Self built during onboarding and participation were governance acts that established obligations and configurations in the FAI network. They close only by governance acts that are symmetric in kind.

8. Conclusion

FAI governance offboarding is the governed wind-down of a Self's FAI participation infrastructure across some or all relationships. It is distinguished from single-relationship exit by its portfolio scope and by the infrastructure-level governance steps — network participation configuration update, governance portfolio closure, and comprehensive offboarding record — that go beyond what any single-relationship exit produces.

The seven-step offboarding sequence (governance decision and record; active event closure; standing configuration revocation; cross-organizational agreement termination; network participation configuration update; governance portfolio closure; offboarding record) closes every layer of FAI participation infrastructure in a governed, traceable order. The governance learning from FAI participation — evolution records, DNA absorptions, governance improvement records — persists in the home substrate after offboarding, as the lasting product of the Self's participation history.

Staged offboarding provides a governance option for Selves that wish to assess whether reduced participation achieves their goals before committing to full termination. The silent

offboarding anti-pattern names the failure mode — governance infrastructure abandoned without formal close-down — whose partner impact extends beyond the offboarding Self's own governance record to the governance clarity of every partner that retains standing configurations and agreements against a Self that has informally exited.

Source papers

Li, W. (2026a). *Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

Li, W. (2026b). *The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model: Extending the Coordination Knowledge Substrate Pattern to AI Selves under Human Governance*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

Li, W. (2026c). *Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration*. April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.